FLAb: Benchmarking deep learning methods for antibody fitness prediction [1]

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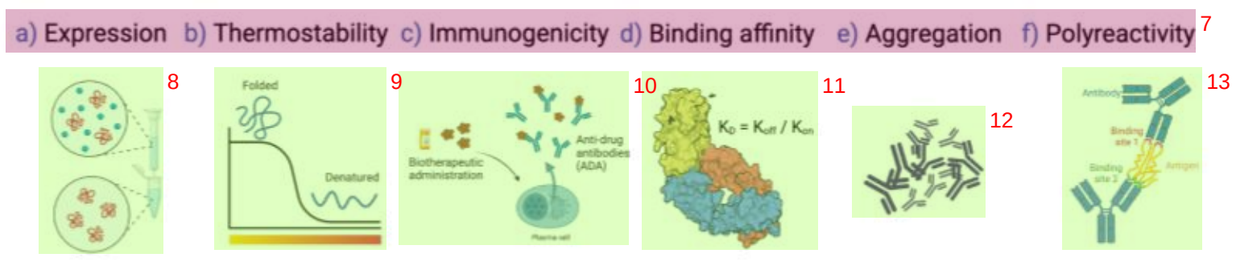
1 Background [5]

Antibody therapeutics must have a particular set of fitness properties [6]



[7] [8] [9] [10] [11] [12] [13]

Six classes of biophysical data relevant to antibody development are (a) expression, (b) thermostability, (c) immunogenicity, (d) binding affinity, (e) aggregation, and (f) polyreactivity [14]

Do deep learning methods capture properties of therapeutic antibodies? [15]

We seek to answer this question by: [16]

1. Creating a collection of datasets of antibody therapeutic data [17]
2. Benchmark representative AI model likelihoods for fitness prediction

2 Dataset curation [18]

We curated publicly available antibody fitness datasets [19]

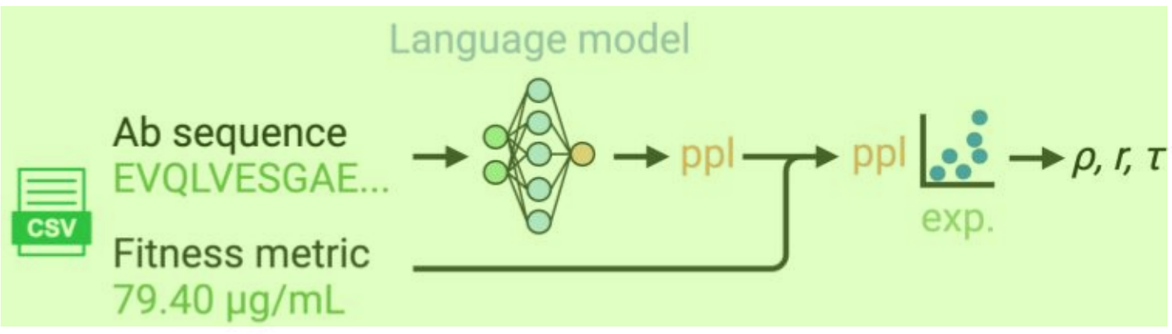
[20]

Dataset	Antibody	Exp. (μg/mL)	T_m (°C)	Imm. (% ADA)	Binding (nM)	Agg. (Wv shift)	Poly. (min)
	GSK CA1	34	34	-	29	-	-
	GSK CA2	25	22	-	22	-	-
	GSK CA3	11	8	-	11	-	-
	GSK CA4	24	24	-	19	-	-
	Hie C143	-	2	-	16	-	-
	Hie mAb114	-	7	-	20	-	-
	Hie mAb114 UCA	-	2	-	-	-	-
	Hie MEDI8852	-	2	-	15	-	-
	Hie MEDI8852 UCA	-	6	-	20	-	-
	Hie REGN10987	-	8	-	13	-	-
	Hie S309	-	10	-	19	-	-
	Koenig G6	4275	-	-	4275	-	-
	Prihoda imm	-	-	217	-	-	-
	Rosace Adalimumab	-	14	-	14	-	14
	Rosace CD3022	-	6	-	6	-	6
	Rosace Golimumab	-	5	-	5	-	5
	Shane. Trast. multi	-	-	-	24	-	-
	Shane. Trast. zero	-	-	-	422	-	-
	Warszawski D44	-	-	-	2049	-	-
	Wittrup CST	274	137	-	-	822	411

This database includes mutational landscapes of 17 distinct antibody families and a total of 13,384 associated fitness metrics. Each sequence is mapped to at least one fitness label pertaining to the 6 fitness properties [21]

3 Methods [22]

Pipeline for benchmarking protein language models [23]

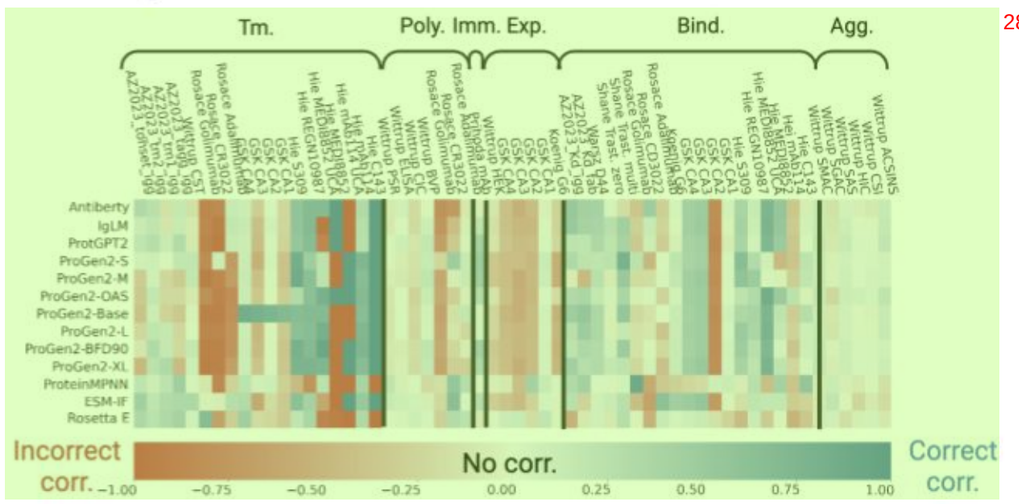


[24]

For each protein language model, we separately input the antibody **heavy** and **light sequences** to return two **perplexity scores**, and we tabulate the average perplexity between the two sequences. We calculate Spearman's (**ρ**), Pearson's (**r**) and Kendall tau's (**τ**) correlation coefficients between **perplexity** and **fitness**. [25]

4 Results [26]

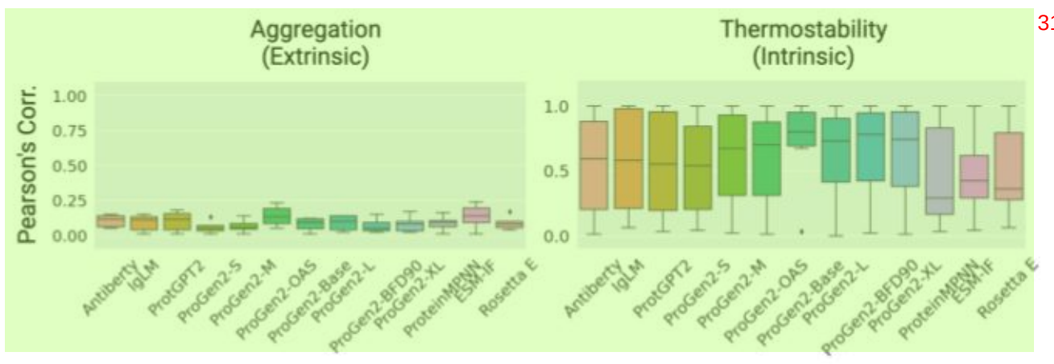
A heat map of model-dataset correlations [27]



[28]

Summary of Pearson's correlations. Models generally perform best with thermostability and binding affinity datasets, but most struggle with aggregation propensity and polyreactivity. [29]

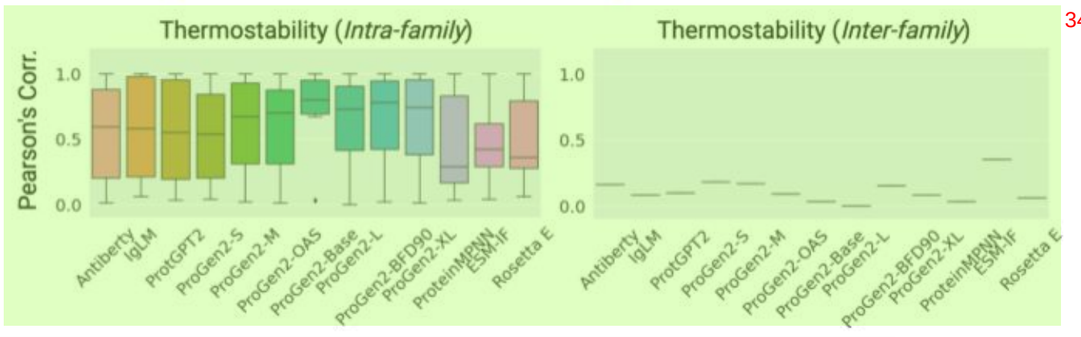
Intrinsic biophysical properties are more accurately predicted than extrinsic [30]



[31]

Intrinsic properties are impacted by inherent properties of the antibody. Extrinsic properties result from target biology and mechanisms of action. [32]

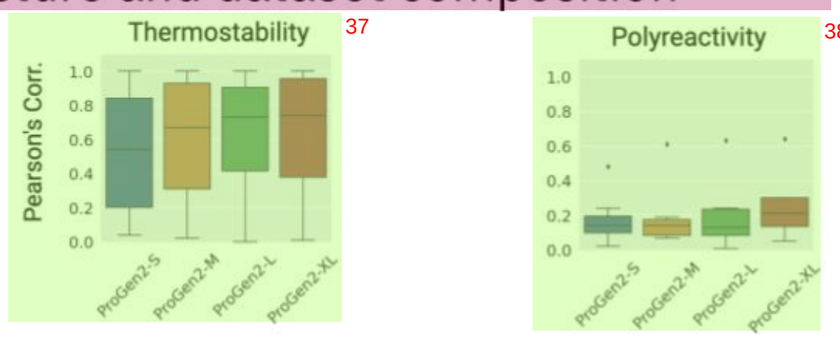
Models are more accurate at distinguishing intra-family versus inter-family antibody sets [33]



[34]

Intra-family antibodies are mutants originating from same wild type. Inter-family antibodies have different wild type origins. [35]

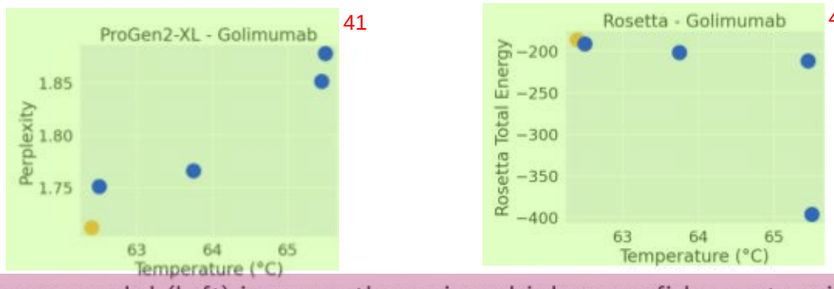
Parameter size influences performance over architecture and dataset composition [36]



[37] [38]

Polyreactivity and thermostability performance correlations improve with parameter size for ProGen2 (151M, 764M, 2.7B, 6.4B parameters) [39]

Some models favor evolutionary signal rather than physical fitness [40]



[41] [42]

The language model (left) incorrectly assigns higher confidence to wild type antibody. Physics-based model (right) correctly assigns higher stability to the mutants [43]

5 Conclusion [44]

FLAb is a living benchmark where we will continuously add models evaluated and available antibody data [45]

No model was top performing across all six fitness classes [46]